

1. Project Description PASS/FAIL A response is required which provides the Department with a clear and concise understanding of the project. If the bidder is seeking a Transformative Project award above \$125,000, up to \$300,000, indicate affirmatively in this response. If the bidder is seeking funding for planning, the description must demonstrate that either; it is for a town/village comprehensive plan and/or land use regulation, or it is for project-specific planning activities, ie. connected with advancement of one or more priority projects. Character Limit: 1,000.

Instructions: Clearly and briefly describe the scope of work your smart growth project will implement. NOTE: You will be asked to provide more detailed project tasks, objectives and performance measures in the Work Plan Properties section in the SFS Grants Management.

Display Bid Response in Modal Window

Response:

The Village of Saranac Lake seeks \$125,000 in Smart Growth funding, plus a \$10,000 local match, to advance accessibility upgrades at Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park through contractual services for construction drawings and bid documents for site improvements/building programming (Phase 1 of project only). This project will produce shovel-ready documents that modernize the beach/bathhouse facility, ensure ADA compliance, and enhance community access. Phase 1 includes design of site improvements and building programming, and the future Phase 2 will include final design of the beach/bathhouse facility. Planned improvements for the full project will include fully accessible restrooms, upgraded lifeguard and staff facilities, new fencing and drainage landscaping, safe pedestrian connections from the parking area to the beach, and barrier-free routes to the waterfront. This project bolsters access for residents and visitors to park nature by increasing accessibility for people of all abilities. The improvements will enhance the current park without taking up any more land or space from the natural beauty that surrounds it.

Lake Colby Beach is one of the Village's most highly used public waterfront spaces, serving residents, seasonal visitors, and families throughout Franklin and Essex County. It is conveniently located adjacent to Rt. 86, clearly visible to those driving by. However, the bathhouse facility is outdated and lacks adequate accessibility, limiting equitable use. By developing detailed construction drawings and bid documents, this project moves a long-standing community priority toward construction readiness. These improvements will expand outdoor recreational opportunities, improve public safety, and guarantee access for all residents and visitors, including people with disabilities. A new modern facility will be an attractive site for those entering the Village from the North, capitalizing on its location and visibility to Rt. 86.

This project directly advances local and regional smart growth principles by reinvesting in a centrally located community asset, strengthening recreational infrastructure, and enhancing quality of life for residents and visitors. Site grading improvements will correct the extensive water runoff issues the park is currently experiencing, leading to erosion of the bathhouse and storm water flowing directly into Lake Colby. These infrastructure improvements will buffer the

park from environmental threats, such as the increase in frequency and intensity of weather related events.

2. Bidder Eligibility PASS/FAIL

For the purposes of this grant program, the following entities are considered eligible bidders:

a. Municipalities, limited to Counties, Towns, or Villages, located wholly or partially within the Park.

b. 501(c)(3) not-for-profit corporations, 501(c)(4) corporations dedicated to environmental quality or community development, and/including any improvement district, soil and water conservation district, or industrial development agency within an eligible county, town or village, provided that 501(c) bidders must have the support of at least one eligible municipal project partner, substantiated by a letter of support.

If a proposed project involves a cooperative agreement or partners, only one eligible, designated lead bidder can submit the bid for grant funding. If the municipality is the lead bidder, a not-for-profit partner does not need to be pre-qualified and may be physically located in a different municipality than the lead bidder municipality.

Character Limit: 250

Instructions: Affirm that an eligible municipality is applying, or if you are a not-for profit 501(c)(3) organization, provide the exact name of the partnering municipal government (ex. Town of, Village of..., etc.). 501(c)(4) must demonstrate their dedication to environmental quality or community development.

Upload Required, if applicable: Not-for-profits must upload a single pdf file that contains a qualifying partnership letter from the partnering municipality. The partnership letter must designate which is the 'Lead' bidder and must identify the partners' roles in the project. Letters should be addressed to the non-profit organization receiving the municipality's support.

Add Comments or Attachments

Display Bid Response in Modal Window

Response

The Village of Saranac Lake, an eligible municipality located wholly within the Adirondack Park, is applying as the lead applicant. The Village is dedicated to environmental quality and community development through sustainable infrastructure, accessible public spaces, and investment in community assets.

3. Site Accessibility; Ownership and Letters of Permission/Municipal Endorsement
PASS/FAIL

The bidder must own the property, or obtain an applicable access agreement, for the proposed project site. An upload is required that shows the current ownership. If the landowner of the

property is an organization other than the 'Lead' bidder, an upload is required to provide written proof from the legal owner(s), agreeing to allow access to the site of the proposed project.

Character Limit: 500

Instructions: Provide the name(s) of the landowner(s) of any property on which the project will be implemented and describe the relationship of the lead bidder to the landowner(s). Provide parcel identification information by entering the County Tax Map Page & Parcel ID for property involved in the project. For plans with no specific property involved, the County Tax Map Page & Parcel ID is not needed. In addition,

Upload Required:

- If the project does not involve a particular project site, upload a brief description describing how the requirements related to ownership of project site are not applicable to the project.
- If the property is owned by the bidder, upload a screenshot/printout of the parcel(s) in the county tax map or, if the county tax map is not current, upload a copy of the current deed.
- If the property is not owned by the bidder, upload a screenshot/printout of the parcel(s) in the county tax map. Also required to be included in the upload is a signed letter of support that includes the tax parcel ID(s). This support letter from the landowner is needed at time of bid. A formal, legally binding access agreement between the bidder and landowner will be required should the bidder receive a grant award and contract involving construction, alteration of the site, or increased public access. For an application that involves purchase of property, the landowner support letter should state that they intend to sell the property to the applicant.
- If the bidder is a not-for-profit proposing a project on municipal property (construction projects and construction plans as well as feasibility studies that involve surveying and environmental assessment), upload a screenshot/printout of the parcel(s) in the county tax map. Also required to be included in the upload is a signed Municipal Endorsement referencing the tax parcel ID(s). A municipal endorsement provides authorization for the not-for-profit to conduct the proposed project on municipal property.
- If the work is to be conducted within a public right-of-way (ROW), a support letter from the entity having jurisdiction will be required. For example, for Town roads, a letter from the Town. For State roads, a letter from NYSDOT Regional office stating they are aware of the application and can support project pursuant to a post-award permit process, is sufficient. There is no need for support letters from property owners adjoining the ROW. The ROW is a separate property / ownership parcel that should have its own tax id # / #s but if not, it can be simply referenced as public right of way.

Add Comments or Attachments deed received

Display Bid Response in Modal Window

Response

4. Project Location: PASS/FAIL

The eligible geographic boundaries are as follows:

Adirondack Park: Projects (or the funded portion of a larger project) must be located wholly within the defined geographic boundaries of the Adirondack Park listed on the last page of this RFB. Comprehensive Plans only may be for Towns/Villages with geographic boundaries inside and outside of the Blue Line and may apply for 100% reimbursement. The geographic boundaries of the Adirondack Park are identified in subdivision 1 of Section 9-0101 of the Environmental Conservation Law. Maps are available from the APA at <http://apa.ny.gov/gis/index.html> or DECinfo Locator at <https://gisservices.dec.ny.gov/gis/dil/index.html?cat=LR>. Please note pdf size limit is 20MB.

Character Limit: 500

Instructions: Provide a location map showing the project in relation to the park boundary. Provide the names of the County and Village or Town in which the project will be implemented. As an exception, parkwide projects can be identified as parkwide and a map of the entire park can be uploaded. Describe the ownership class of any land involved in the project (public, private, combination of public/private) as well as (if applicable) the Adirondack Park Land Use and Development Plan (APL DP) classification for any private lands.

Upload Required: Location Map

Add Comments or Attachments (Attach doc)

Display Bid Response in Modal Window

Response

The Phase 1 Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park Accessibility Upgrade project is located wholly within the Adirondack Park at 4 Moir Rd, Village of Saranac Lake, Town of Harrietstown, Franklin County, NY. The property is owned by the Village of Saranac Lake (Public Land). Attached is a location map showing the project site in relation to the Adirondack Park boundary. No private lands are involved, and the project is fully within the park's Blue Line.

5. Project Area PASS/FAIL/

In addition to the Project Location map, all projects that involve a project location or project area must provide an area map that clearly displays the project in relation to neighboring parcels (if applicable), municipal boundaries, hamlet/community centers, natural resource assets and recreational lands. The area map is intended to show the layout of the project within the surrounding landscape. Comprehensive plan applications must include a townwide map. Please note pdf size limit is 20MB.

Instructions: Describe the project location and upload an area map. Bidders may use a county mapping utility, USGS topographical sheets on-line available at <http://www.usgs.gov/pubprod/> or DEC's State Lands Interactive Mapper at DECinfo Locator at <https://gisservices.dec.ny.gov/gis/dil/index.html?cat=LR..>

- If the project involves an entire Town or an area larger than a single Town, Upload is optional; enter a brief description of the area.
- If the project involves more than one site, Upload is required for each site.

Character Limit: 1,000

Upload Required, if applicable: Area Map(s)

Add Comments or Attachments (Include Project Area Doc)

Display Bid Response in Modal Window
Response

Phase 1 Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park Accessibility Upgrade project is located at 4 Moir Road, Village of Saranac Lake, Town of Harrietstown, Franklin County, NY. The project site is a publicly owned Village property on the eastern shore of Lake Colby, a well-used recreational asset. The attached area map shows the beach in relation to neighboring parcels, municipal boundaries, nearby residential areas, public roads, and natural resource features, including Lake Colby and its surrounding green space.

Centrally located within the Village, the park serves residents, seasonal visitors, and families throughout the region. Its proximity to Rt. 86 makes it a visible and highly accessible community gateway. The map illustrates how the project ties into existing recreational infrastructure—such as parking, walking paths, and nearby public facilities—while highlighting opportunities to improve accessibility, public safety, and equitable community access to this important waterfront resource.

6. Site Plans, Photos and Permits PASS/FAIL/N/A

All construction or development bids must include clear drawings, maps, photos or plans of existing and proposed natural and man-made conditions on the project site and the areas immediately adjacent to the site. This documentation should clearly represent the current conditions of the project site and show any areas to be disturbed. Photos should be keyed to maps. In addition, bidders are required to discuss permit requirements, ground disturbance, and archaeological considerations related to the project/property.

Instructions: For construction projects: 1) list all state, federal or local permits anticipated for the project, including those already obtained, 2) describe to what extent, if any, ground disturbance will be involved in the proposed project (such as for grading, installation of underground utilities, etc.), 3) if applicable, describe the relevant sections of any archeological studies that have been

conducted or archeological proposals that have been prepared for the project/property. If the project does not require permits, you must answer this question with 'Not Applicable' and state the reason why no permits are required.

Character Limit: 1,000

Upload Required, if applicable: Upload one pdf file containing photo(s) that clearly represent the current conditions of the project site and a site plan that represents the project areas to be disturbed. Please note pdf size limit is 20MB.

Add Comments or Attachments

Display Bid Response in Modal Window
Response

Not Applicable. This project involves only the contractual services for construction drawings & bid documents for accessibility upgrades at Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park. No actual construction, ground disturbance, or permit requirements will occur under this phase of the project.

7. State Environmental Quality Review (SEQR) PASS/FAIL/N/A

A. Bidders must fulfill the requirements of the State Environmental Quality Review Act (SEQR). Bids involving construction or development will not be considered eligible for a grant without the completion of SEQR requirements detailed below. Information about SEQR and related forms are available and downloadable on the DEC's website:

<https://dec.ny.gov/regulatory/permits-licenses/seqr> Type II projects are not subject to further SEQR review once the activity is classified as Type II (see Part 617.5 of the SEQR regulations to determine if a project is a Type II). No Environmental Assessment Form or determination of significance is required for actions which are Type II.

A note should be placed in your organization's internal project file explaining that the project is a Type II action and identify which Type II criterion best fits (i.e. (1) maintenance or repair involving no substantial changes in an existing structure or facility).

B. SEQR Forms:

If your project is not Type II, it will be subject to SEQR review. Consult section 617.4 of the SEQR regulations to determine if it is classified Type I or Unlisted. If the project is classified as Type I, the Full Environmental Assessment Form (EAF) is used for the SEQR review. For Unlisted actions, the Short EAF is used.

Not-For-Profit Corporations:

The DEC will conduct lead agency SEQR review for all not-for-profit bidders. Not-for-profit corporations are required to complete, sign and submit Part 1 of either the Short or the Full EAF, depending on the classification of the action.

Municipalities:

The eligible municipality will likely be the lead agency for SEQR if the DEC is the only other involved State agency or will be responsible for initiating lead agency designation procedures if there are other involved State agencies. The lead agency designation is required to determine the environmental significance of the project under SEQR. Municipal agencies acting as the SEQR lead agency must complete and sign Parts 1, 2 and 3 of either the Short or Full EAF.

If the project's impacts have been previously reviewed under SEQR, supporting documentation of the completed SEQR review must be submitted (e.g., negative declaration, FEIS and SEQR Findings Statement).

Instructions: If your project is a Type II action or is not construction or development related, please answer this question with 'not-applicable' and explain why SEQR is not required for the project. Otherwise, upload one pdf file containing the appropriate SEQR documents for your project and explain the decision-making process behind the documents uploaded.

Character Limit: 1,000

Upload Required, if applicable:

If the lead bidder is a not-for-profit: Complete and upload Part 1 of the Full Environmental Assessment Form (EAF).

If the lead bidder is a municipality: Municipal bidders may determine their project is Unlisted, in which case, they must upload the ShortEAF. For all other municipal bids, upload Part 1 of the Full EAF. If the SEQR process has been fully completed, upload final SEQR determinations and all forms.

Add Comments or Attachments

Display Bid Response in Modal Window

Response (Attach resolution once approved)

8. Universal Access PASS/FAIL

Bidders must incorporate ADA standards in design, layout, and construction and address future needs in planning. Bidders should use the principles of Universal Design, <https://universaldesign.ie/what-is-universal-design/the-7-principles/>, in project development and implementation, including incorporation of ADA guidelines and ABA for Outdoor Developed Areas.

Character Limit: 1,000

Instructions: State whether the principles of Universal Design are relevant to the project, and if applicable, describe how the project will utilize principles of Universal Design. Bidders are strongly encouraged to upload any supporting documentation to assist reviewers in their assessment. Any methods or deliverables related to universal design described in Program Question 8 must be itemized in the Grantee Defined Work Plan.

Upload is optional: You may upload additional documentation to support your response

Add Comments or Attachments

Display Bid Response in Modal Window

Response

Phase 1 Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park Accessibility Upgrade project (construction drawings and bid documents for site development, and building programming) will incorporate ADA standards and ABA guidelines for Outdoor Developed Areas, guided by the 7 Principles of Universal Design. Plans will ensure equitable use of restrooms, pathways, and waterfront access for people of all abilities; provide flexibility through multiple mobility options and adaptable seating; and use intuitive layouts with clear signage and wayfinding. Designs will incorporate perceptible information through visual, tactile, and auditory cues, while enhancing safety with slip-resistant surfaces and accessible transitions. Low physical effort will be prioritized for independent use of ramps and facilities, and adequate size and space will be included for wheelchairs, strollers, and families. Together, these principles will ensure the park is inclusive, safe, and future-ready for all visitors. Design of bathhouse to be included in Phase 2.

9. Please sign and upload the Attachment S Sexual Harassment form.

Enter File Attachment Response [\(Attach Doc\)](#)

10. Please sign and upload the Executive Order 16 form.

Enter File Attachment Response [Attach Doc](#)

11. Smart Growth Infrastructure Policy Act PASS/FAIL

New York State's Smart Growth Public Infrastructure Policy Act (ACT), Environmental Conservation Law Article 6, requires the Department and all State infrastructure agencies to assess whether each public infrastructure project that receives state funding is consistent with the State Smart Growth Public Infrastructure criteria specified in the Act, or that compliance is impracticable, before making any commitment to fund such project(s).

Instructions: In the SFS Grants Management Events, Comments and Attachments screen section of the bid, ALL bidders must download, complete and save the Smart Growth Assessment form, prior to uploading the completed form back into the SFS Grants Management at this question. Important note: Be sure to check the form after uploading to ensure the correct file is uploaded and is completed as required.

Enter File Attachment Response 9 [\(Smart Assessment Form attach\)](#)

12. Alignment with the Special Conditions of the Adirondack Park 18 POINTS: A response is required that demonstrates how the project is consistent with the special conditions discussed

in #6 Scoring Criteria, Part B, above. This response should include how the project will do the following:

- bolster or capitalize on the existing strengths of the park;
- address the challenges of current conditions or propose targeted improvements for the park;
- allow the community or organization to take advantage of potential opportunities within the context of the park; and
- buffer the Park from environmental or economic threats.

Instructions: Describe in detail how the project is consistent with the Special Conditions of the Adirondack Park, including a summary of the need and purpose for the project.

(A) Bidder demonstrated that the project is aligned with the special conditions of the Park and goes above and beyond in its effort to bolster or capitalize on the existing strengths of the Park, address the challenges of current conditions, take advantage of opportunities within the context of the Park, or buffer the Park from threats. 18 pts.

(B) Bidder demonstrated that the project is aligned with the special conditions of the Park and will contribute toward efforts to bolster or capitalize on the existing strengths of the Park, address the challenges of current conditions, take advantage of opportunities within the context of the Park, or buffer the Park from threats. 15 pts.

(C) Bidder demonstrated that the project is aligned with the special conditions of the Park. However, the bidder did not demonstrate that the project will contribute toward efforts to bolster or capitalize on the existing strengths of the Park, address the challenges of current conditions, take advantage of opportunities within the context of the Park or buffer the Park from threats. 10 pts.

(D) Bidder did not demonstrate that the project aligns with the special conditions of the Park. 0 pts.

Display Bid Response in Modal Window
Response

Phase 1 Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park Accessibility Upgrade project is strongly aligned with the Special Conditions of the Adirondack Park. Lake Colby Beach is one of the Village of Saranac Lake's most popular public recreation areas, providing swimming, picnicking, open space, and waterfront access that draw both residents and visitors. This project bolsters one of the Park's greatest strengths—its tradition of high-quality, nature-based recreation—by ensuring that these opportunities are fully accessible to people of all ages and abilities.

The project directly addresses the challenges of current conditions: outdated infrastructure, inadequate accessibility, and stormwater runoff that contributes to erosion and threatens water quality. Through shovel-ready plans, the Village will be prepared to implement durable, ADA-compliant, and environmentally sound improvements that resolve these issues and safeguard Lake Colby for future generations.

The project also positions the community to seize opportunities within the Park by advancing a long-standing local priority into construction readiness. A modernized, accessible Lake Colby

Beach will expand outdoor recreation, increase equitable access, and enhance public safety. These improvements strengthen tourism amenities and create ripple effects for small businesses, hospitality services, and year-round economic vitality, while also enriching the daily lives of residents.

Finally, the project buffers the Park from environmental and economic threats. Environmentally, designs will incorporate sustainable grading, drainage, and erosion-control strategies to protect water quality and scenic resources. Economically, an inclusive and universally accessible public space broadens the visitor base and strengthens the region's resilience to fluctuations in tourism by diversifying who can participate in Park experiences.

In summary, this project builds on the Adirondack Park's strengths, addresses pressing local challenges, leverages opportunities for community and economic growth, and implements design solutions that buffer the Park from future environmental and economic risks. Lake Colby Beach will emerge as a model of sustainable, inclusive, community-centered recreation that embodies the Park's balance of conservation, accessibility, and vitality.

13. Environmental Quality 6 POINTS: NOTE: Response N/A for Comprehensive Plan applications.

A response is required that demonstrates the extent to which the project is consistent with maintaining the environmental quality of the park and/or will enhance environmental quality. Tree planting will score points in this question as part of 25Million Trees project.

Instructions: Describe in detail how the project supports this scoring criteria.

Add Comments or Attachments

Display Bid Response in Modal Window

Response

Phase 1 Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park Accessibility Upgrade project is fully consistent with maintaining and enhancing the environmental quality of the Adirondack Park. While this phase focuses on planning and design rather than construction, it establishes the foundation for environmentally responsible improvements that protect the park's natural resources.

The construction drawings and bid documents, and building programming, will integrate sustainable design principles to minimize site disturbance, control stormwater runoff, protect water quality in Lake Colby, and preserve surrounding green space. Environmentally sensitive strategies, such as grading and drainage improvements, will reduce erosion and maintain the integrity of the waterfront.

Phase 1 will also identify opportunities for tree planting and landscaping with native species, which aligns with the 25Million Trees initiative. These efforts will enhance scenic beauty, provide shade and comfort for park users, support biodiversity, and contribute to carbon sequestration.

By planning accessibility upgrades with environmental stewardship in mind, the project ensures that future construction will balance recreational use with conservation goals, safeguarding open space, protecting natural habitats, and enhancing the overall environmental quality of this heavily used public resource.

14. Community Centered Growth 6 POINTS

NOTE: Response N/A for Comprehensive Plan applications.

A response is required that demonstrates how the project encourages development in community centers or development that is otherwise compatible with resource protection and community character.

Instructions: Describe in detail how the project supports this scoring criteria.

Add Comments or Attachments

Display Bid Response in Modal Window

Response

Phase 1 Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park Accessibility Upgrade project supports community-centered growth by enhancing one of the Village of Saranac Lake's most popular public recreation areas. While not located in the central business district, Lake Colby Beach is a well-established community hub providing year-round recreational opportunities and serving residents, seasonal visitors, and families from across the region.

Through this design phase, the project strengthens the park's role as a community gathering space while remaining compatible with the Adirondack Park's resource protection goals and community character. The planned improvements ensure inclusivity, sustainability, and long-term usability without compromising the natural setting.

The upgraded site will broaden the range of activities the park can host. Beyond traditional swimming and family recreation, the accessible infrastructure and modernized building will enable school programs, environmental education, water safety courses, fitness and wellness classes, and community workshops or special events. These enhancements position Lake Colby Beach as a year-round destination that serves diverse community needs and encourages social engagement.

By investing in existing public assets in this thoughtful and strategic way, the project reinforces the Village's identity, supports community vitality, and promotes growth that is consistent with both environmental stewardship and local priorities.

15. Quality of Life / Social Impact 6 POINTS

NOTE: Response N/A for Comprehensive Plan applications.

A response is required that demonstrates how the project will benefit the quality of life for residents of the park and/or address social issues.

Instructions: Describe in detail how the project supports this scoring criteria.

Add Comments or Attachments

Display Bid Response in Modal Window

Response

Phase 1 Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park Accessibility Upgrade project will enhance the quality of life and social well-being for residents and visitors of Saranac Lake. By ensuring full accessibility for people of all ages and abilities, the project addresses social challenges such as limited inclusive recreation, barriers for individuals with disabilities, and the need for safe, structured activities for youth and families.

An accessible, well-designed park fosters physical activity, outdoor learning, and social interaction. Upgraded facilities will support programs including school field trips, water safety courses, fitness classes, and community events, promoting health, education, and intergenerational engagement. These improvements strengthen social cohesion and equitable access to recreation, enhancing overall livability.

By creating a welcoming destination for all, the project supports long-term residency, community stability, and a sustainable local economy, encouraging use of local services and tourism. The project aligns with Smart Growth priorities by improving livability, social equity, and community vitality, ensuring Lake Colby Beach remains a safe, accessible, and multifunctional public space for current and future generations.

16. Secondary / Add-On Effects 6 POINTS

NOTE: Response N/A for Comprehensive Plan applications.

A response is required that demonstrates how the project will leverage other positive improvements (i.e., community enhancements, future investment and/or economic activity) due to its high profile, creativity, strategic location, exposure and buy-in via partnerships, effectiveness, replicability and/or necessity.

Instructions: Describe in detail how the project supports this scoring criteria.

Add Comments or Attachments

Display Bid Response in Modal Window

Response

Phase 1 Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park Accessibility Upgrade project will generate benefits that extend far beyond the immediate project. By producing construction-ready site plans and building programming, this effort positions the park for future capital improvements, complementary investments, and expanded programming.

Accessible and high-quality public amenities strengthen Saranac Lake's identity as a welcoming, vibrant community. Lake Colby Beach, already a central gathering place, will gain

visibility as a year-round recreational hub, encouraging partnerships with schools, local organizations, and regional initiatives. These enhancements will spur greater use of the park, support community events, and expand opportunities for environmental education and wellness programs.

The project creates economic ripple effects by increasing visitor activity, boosting local businesses, and making the Village more attractive to prospective residents. As a model of thoughtful, sustainable investment, the project is replicable in other Adirondack communities seeking to balance accessibility, recreation, and environmental stewardship.

Overall, the accessibility upgrades act as a catalyst for long-term social, economic, and community benefits, reinforcing Lake Colby Beach as a cornerstone of Saranac Lake's quality of life and future vitality.

17. Tourism Enhancement 6 POINTS

NOTE: Response N/A for Comprehensive Plan applications.

A response is required that demonstrates whether the project will enhance the tourism economic sector by contributing to the establishment of tourism amenities, support services, attractions, accommodations and infrastructure.

Instructions: Describe in detail how the project supports this scoring criteria.

Add Comments or Attachments

Display Bid Response in Modal Window

Response

Phase 1 Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park Accessibility Upgrade project will strengthen Saranac Lake's tourism economy by laying the groundwork for high-quality, inclusive improvements at the community's only public, lifeguarded beach. These plans will ensure that upgrades are designed to be safe, accessible, and welcoming for residents, visitors, and seasonal homeowners of all ages and abilities.

As the Village's only lifeguarded swimming area, Lake Colby Beach is already a vital recreational asset. Planned enhancements will expand its role as a year-round destination, supporting a variety of event and course programming. These offerings enrich the visitor experience, complement Adirondack Park's natural and cultural character, and reinforce Saranac Lake's reputation as a vibrant, welcoming hub for outdoor recreation.

By investing in accessibility and sustainable design, this project enhances a unique tourism amenity that attracts families, seniors, and visitors, while stimulating local business activity. The improvements will position Lake Colby Beach as a multifunctional recreational and tourism anchor, supporting both community vitality and long-term regional tourism goals.

18. Sustainable Economic Impact 6 POINTS

NOTE: Response N/A for Comprehensive Plan applications.

A response is required that demonstrates how the project will benefit the maintenance and/or improvement of the sustainable economy in the park. Include whether or not the project will advance the number of seasons that businesses will be active, develop new uses for existing resources, and/or add value to current economic outputs to keep profits in the region.

Instructions: Describe in detail how the project supports this scoring criteria.

Upload is optional: You may upload a Regional Economic Development Plan supportive narrative or Add a supportive narrative

Add Comments or Attachments

Display Bid Response in Modal Window
Response

Phase 1 Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park Accessibility Upgrade project directly supports the North Country Regional Economic Development Council's (NCREDC) strategies by advancing placemaking, increasing accessibility to tourism assets, expanding four-season recreational opportunities, and investing in resilient infrastructure. By preparing construction drawings and bid documents for accessibility upgrades, the project ensures that future improvements to one of the Village of Saranac Lake's most important public spaces will align with these regional priorities while preserving the Adirondack Park's natural character.

Upgraded and accessible facilities strengthen the park's role as a community hub, directly supporting the REDC's placemaking priority by creating a safe, welcoming, and inclusive destination for all residents and visitors. This improves quality of life and enhances the Village's ability to attract and retain workforce talent, reinforcing Saranac Lake's identity as a vibrant year-round community.

The project also supports the REDC goal of expanding four-season recreational opportunities by enabling programming beyond summer swimming. Planned improvements will support fall foliage events, environmental education, school programs, and winter activities like ice fishing and snowshoeing. This diversification extends the tourism season, sustains small businesses, and contributes to the REDC's focus on growing the year-round tourism economy.

Additionally, the project addresses the REDC priority of resilient infrastructure by incorporating environmentally sound design solutions that mitigate stormwater erosion, improve accessibility, and ensure long-term sustainability. These measures safeguard Lake Colby's water quality and surrounding open space while protecting the park's recreational and economic value.

In sum, this project strengthens the REDC's regional strategies by enhancing accessibility, supporting sustainable tourism, and investing in resilient community infrastructure—making

Lake Colby Beach a model for balanced economic growth, resource protection, and year-round vitality in the Adirondack Park.

19. Planning Support 5 POINTS

NOTE: Response N/A for Comprehensive Plan applications.

A response is required that demonstrates how the project will build on previous community planning and economic development activities; by implementing a specific strategy or objective; and/or by achieving a broader goal or policy. State if the project is identified as a critical or important implementation step within previous plans.

Instructions: Describe in detail how the project supports this scoring criteria.

Upload is optional: You may upload excerpts from associated planning documents. (LWRP, Comprehensive Plan, Parks Vision Plan, Monarch community designation and Tree City) When uploading plans, please include only the pages pertinent to this bid and label the name of the plan at the top or include the plan's cover page. Plans uploaded in their entirety can detract from an otherwise focused and concise application.

Add Comments or Attachments

Display Bid Response in Modal Window

Response

Phase 1 Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park Accessibility Upgrade builds on the Village of Saranac Lake's planning and economic initiatives, including the Comprehensive Plan, Local Waterfront Revitalization Program (LWRP), Parks Vision Plan, Tree City USA, and Monarch Friendly Community certification. The Comprehensive Plan emphasizes community-centered growth, reinvestment in public assets, and quality of life. The LWRP identifies Lake Colby Beach as a priority for improved accessibility, modernized facilities, and safe waterfront access.

The Parks Vision Plan underscores accessibility, inclusive recreation, and environmental stewardship, guiding improvements that support visitor enjoyment and ecological health. Monarch Friendly emphasizes pollinator-friendly landscaping, native plantings, and sustainable habitat design. Tree City USA reflects the Village's commitment to urban forestry and green infrastructure, integrated into landscaping and stormwater management improvements.

Producing shovel-ready construction drawings and bid documents translates these priorities into actionable improvements that modernize infrastructure, ensure ADA compliance, and enhance equitable access for residents and visitors of all ages and abilities. It reflects Smart Growth principles by reinvesting in an existing hub, strengthening recreation while preserving Lake Colby's natural character.

Overall, this project advances local and regional goals by improving infrastructure, supporting inclusive recreation, reinforcing community identity, and fostering long-term economic and social vitality aligned with Village planning efforts and Adirondack Park priorities.

20. Professional Experience 5 POINTS

A response is required that demonstrates how the staff and/or volunteers of the bidder, partners, and/or professional consultants responsible for implementing the project exhibit sufficient qualifications, skills, experience, and/or capabilities that will improve the final product.

Instructions: Describe in detail how the project supports this scoring criteria.

Upload is optional: You may upload additional documentation such as business resumes to support your response.

Add Comments or Attachments (Include resumes)

Display Bid Response in Modal Window

Response

The Village of Saranac Lake has assembled a team of highly qualified staff, including the Village Manager, and professional consultants to ensure successful delivery of the Phase 1 Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park Accessibility Upgrade project. The Community Development Department, under the oversight of the Village Manager, has extensive experience managing complex, grant-funded projects, including park renovations, recreation infrastructure upgrades, and public programming initiatives. Staff expertise includes multi-stakeholder coordination, grant compliance, contractor oversight, and project delivery on time and within budget.

Professional consultants with specialized expertise in design, construction management, environmental compliance, and accessibility standards will be selected through a competitive bid process once funding is secured. This approach ensures the Village engages qualified professionals to produce construction drawings and bid documents that meet all state and federal standards and result in a high-quality, implementable project.

The combination of experienced Village staff, the Village Manager, and competitively selected consultants provides the skills and capabilities necessary to deliver a successful, accessible, and sustainable park improvement project that will benefit residents and visitors for years to come.

21. Partnership, Involvement, & Public Support 5 POINTS

A response is required that demonstrates the extent to which staff and/or volunteers responsible for implementing the project have substantial support from one or more of the following: project partner(s), civic leadership, a highly involved core of individual supporters (ie. a steering group or a dedicated project committee) and/or broad support (ie. involvement of community volunteers/ civic groups, and/or previous public engagement around the project).

Instructions: Describe in detail how the project supports this scoring criteria.

Upload is optional: You may upload additional documentation to support your response such as letters of support, newspaper clippings, and press releases.

Add Comments or Attachments (Include Letters of Support, and any public engagement including press releases)

Display Bid Response in Modal Window
Response

Phase 1 Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park Accessibility Upgrade project has strong support from Village leadership and the community. Identified through the Village's LWRP, which included extensive public engagement, the project reflects resident priorities and addresses diverse needs.

The Village Board, Village Manager, and Community Development Department will oversee the design and bid document phase, while local organizations and agencies have expressed support for its role in enhancing access, recreation, and tourism. Letters of support and local media coverage document this broad-based backing, ensuring the project aligns with community priorities and fosters transparent, inclusive planning.

22. Project Readiness 5 POINTS

A response is required that demonstrates the extent to which the project is ready for completion and how the project can successfully be completed within a three-year contract term. Are all required permits in place, the scope of work clearly defined, and project planning thoroughly completed?

Instructions: Describe in detail how the project supports this scoring criteria.

Upload is optional: You may upload additional documentation to support your response such as research findings, project scoping documents, concept plans, sketch maps, site plans, marketing plans, preliminary approvals, etc.

Add Comments or Attachments
Display Bid Response in Modal Window
Response

Phase 1 Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park Accessibility Upgrade project is ready to proceed, pending funding. This phase will produce detailed, shovel-ready documents to guide construction. The Village of Saranac Lake, as property owner, fully supports the project and will coordinate required approvals. Village staff, including the Village Manager and Community Development Department, will oversee the work, and professional consultants will be selected through a competitive bid process. With project scope defined and ownership secured, this phase is prepared for immediate execution.

23. Program Emphasis Criteria 4 POINTS

NOTE: Response N/A for Comprehensive Plan applications.

Is the project a Regional or Parkwide Project AND/OR is the project focused on enhancing availability of affordable housing?

A. Regional - projects are those that involve three or more municipal governments located in a similar geographic region of the Adirondack Park.

B. Park-wide - projects are those that involve at least two municipal governments and have a Park-wide scope. Park-wide projects must address conditions throughout the Adirondack Park for purposes including, but not limited to, tourism and marketing of the park, private investment, environmental protection, capacity building or community housing.

C. Affordable Housing projects' primary goal or outcome is to enhance availability of affordable housing.

Instructions: Yes/No response is required. If yes, state which type the project is; Regional, Park-wide, or Affordable Housing and provide the exact name of the municipal government(s) (ex. Town of..., Village of..., etc.) involved. If the project is Park-wide, you must also describe how your project will implement a park-wide scope of work. If the project is for Affordable Housing, you must demonstrate that affordable housing is the primary goal or outcome of the project.

Upload: For regional/parkwide projects to earn points, an upload is also needed; upload a single pdf file that contains a qualifying partnership letter from each partnering municipality.

Add Comments or Attachments

Display Bid Response in Modal Window
Response

No. This project is not Regional, Park-wide, or focused on affordable housing. It does, however, support the Adirondack Park's program emphasis as a Park-focused initiative within the Village of Saranac Lake by improving accessibility, ensuring equitable use, enhancing community vitality, and supporting sustainable tourism and the local economy.

24. Supplemental Criteria 2 POINTS

A response is required stating if the project is located in or designed to benefit an Environmental Justice community or if the lead bidder or municipal partner is a Climate Smart Community. If either is true, two points will be assigned. If both are true, only the maximum of two points will be assigned.

The Department demonstrates a commitment to Environmental Justice (EJ) and remedies for communities that may be burdened by negative environmental consequences. Environmental

Justice is defined by the DEC as the fair treatment and meaningful involvement of all people, regardless of race, color or income, with respect to the development, implementation and enforcement of environmental laws, regulations and policies. Maps of EJ areas in New York State are available at: <https://www.dec.ny.gov/public/911.html> or Potential Environmental Justice Area PEJA Communities | Potential Environmental Justice Area PEJA Communities | NYS GIS Clearinghouse

Climate Smart Communities is a network of New York communities engaged in reducing greenhouse gas emissions and improving climate resilience. Climate change affects every community in New York - economically, socially and environmentally. As the first line of response in emergencies, as the proprietors of critical infrastructure and as the governments with immediate responsibility for public health and safety, municipalities face a critical challenge in confronting and responding to climate change. A community becomes a Climate Smart Community by adopting the Climate Smart Communities Pledge; a public declaration of leadership and commitment to reducing emissions and adapting to a changing climate. (see <https://climatesmart.ny.gov/actions-certification/participating-communities/> for more information)

Instructions: Yes/No response is required. If yes, state which qualification applies; Environmental Justice Area, Climate Smart Community, or both.

Add Comments or Attachments (Climate Smart Certification)

Display Bid Response in Modal Window

Response

Yes. The Village of Saranac Lake is a recertified Bronze Climate Smart Community. This designation reflects the Village's ongoing commitment to climate resilience, sustainability, and improving public infrastructure while reducing environmental impacts. While the park is not located within a designated Environmental Justice area, the Downtown area of the Village is. The project still enhances equitable access to public recreational spaces for residents and visitors of all ages and abilities. This aligns with the Village's ongoing commitment to sustainability, climate resilience, and social equity, ensuring that public infrastructure improvements support both environmental and community well-being.

25. Cost Effectiveness 1 Local Contribution 5 POINTS

Although there is no match requirement, projects that bring in additional non-State, non-Federal resources to complement grant funding may be eligible to receive up to five (5) additional points in the project scoring. The dollar value of any additional resources needed to fully deliver the project work plan must be clearly defined by the Bidder and entered in the Expenditure Based Budget section of the bid.

Instructions: Briefly describe the total amount and source(s) of local contribution (non-State, non-Federal). Separately, describe any other State and Federal commitments in order to represent the totality of project funding. IMPORTANT: while this description is helpful to reviewers, in order to receive points for local contribution, the actual expenditure details must be included in the Expenditure Based Budget section of the bid and categorized as Match.

Upload is optional: You may upload additional documentation to support your response, such as overall project estimates, quotes and bids related to local contribution and proofs of project-associated commitments.

Add Comments or Attachments

Display Bid Response in Modal Window **Attach Resolution from Board for match**
Response

Phase 1 of the project will include a \$10,000 local contribution from the Village of Saranac Lake as a non-State, non-Federal match.

26. Cost Effectiveness 2 Budget Detail and Reasonableness of Expenses 7 POINTS
A response is required that demonstrates the reasonableness of expenses.

Instructions: Ensure that sufficient details have been entered in the Expenditure Based Budget forms to allow reviewers to fully understand the anticipated costs. Describe in detail how the project attains cost effectiveness; how costs are reasonable and justified and how the use of different categories of expenses are applicable to accomplishing the work plan. Compare proposed project costs to other similar work. Explain how your choice of cost components will contribute toward project outcomes. Explain the reasoning behind the balance of expenses across budget categories, for example, In our community, the DPW can most efficiently complete project components; specifically, or Our organization lacks the internal capacity to do X so we will competitively bid these services under the contractual services line.

Upload required: You must upload documentation to support the estimated budget amounts. To respond effectively to this question, bidders may support the overall cost with a comparable project cost comparison and/or support each significant expenditure with documentation, such as; standard government wage rates, current market prices for equipment, and cost-estimates from potential contractors/vendors.

Upload requirement detail: If the budget contains contractual services and/or equipment valued at \$2,500 or more per-item, two informal quotes must be uploaded for each such item or service. A full project feasibility study including pricing, or a detailed in-house estimate may replace the two-quote requirement.

Add Comments or Attachments

Display Bid Response in Modal Window **attach proposal from MJ**
Response

Phase 1 focuses on producing shovel-ready construction drawings and bid documents, ensuring funds directly support project readiness. Costs are reasonable based on market rates, comparable municipal park projects, and historical Village project costs. The Village will competitively bid all design and bid preparation work, as it lacks internal capacity for professional construction documents. Budget allocations prioritize contractual services for

design while covering administrative oversight and contingency. Supporting documentation are provided to demonstrate cost effectiveness and justify expenditures. Each expense is aligned with achieving ADA-compliant improvements and preparing for future construction.

27. Cost Effectiveness 3 Eligible Costs 2 POINTS

No response is necessary. This bid component will be scored based on budget entries. See Article 6: Scoring Criteria for scoring criteria details.

Display Bid Response in Modal Window
Response

28. Cost Effectiveness 4 Security of Investment 6 POINTS

NOTE: No response is necessary. This bid component will be scored based on budget and work plan entries. See Article 6: Scoring Criteria for scoring criteria details.